
ALL-TEAMS RETREAT · THURSDAY, MAY 8, 2026

Building the Road *Together*

Student Health & Wellness · University of Utah · Division of Student Affairs

Today is the response.

You filled out a survey. Forty of you. Some honest. Some vulnerable. A few angry.

One of you wrote: “I wish we could speak plainly.”



The cleanest gift this retreat can give back is to ***speak plainly in return.***

That's what today is.

We care about students.

Even through burnout. Even through disappointment.

That is not a given. That is the foundation everything else is built on.

“

Put the student first. I believe the division genuinely cares about the students and it shows.

“

Our staff care. Even through burnout and disappointment, we care about the students.

“

There's a genuine dedication to helping students feel supported and succeed.

PART ONE

What the survey said

n = 40 honest responses

Connection holds. Awareness doesn't.

CONNECTION TO MISSION

3.48

out of 5

23 of 40 staff at 4 or above. Mission connection holds.

INFORMED ABOUT ROADMAP

2.82

out of 5

26 of 40 at 3 or below. Only 2 rated a 5.

Staff care about the work. They just don't always know where it's going. That's a solvable problem.

9 : 5 0 A M · T H E M O S T I M P O R T A N T B L O C K O F T H E D A Y

You Asked.

We Answer.

Compensation · Accountability · Silos · Communication · Trust

What you told us.

01

Cross-departmental silos

≈31 of 40

02

Roadmap & strategic direction

≈18 of 40

03

**Compensation, retention,
equity**

≈12 of 40

04

Appreciation & validation

≈14 of 40

05

Referral pathways (clinical)

≈8 of 40

06

Decision-making transparency

≈16 of 40

07

Trust & psychological safety

≈8 of 40 — new

Silos

≈31 of 40 raised it

YOU ASKED

Not knowing what other departments work on. Duplicate efforts. Wanting structured ways to learn each other's work.

WE ANSWER

- Peer Health Navigators connect students across our units.
- Layer 1 Referral Coordination Program via the MediCat platform will route referrals so students aren't carrying their own information across silos.
 - Upcoming pilot with CCW + UCC.
 - The work is making sure students know why signing one helps them navigate care.
 - Cross-collaboration cannot be relationship-driven only.

Communication

Across many responses

YOU ASKED

*Direct communication coming down the line.
How decisions are made. Where budget
priorities come from.*

WE ANSWER

Continued:

- New-staff 30-minute meet-and-greet is standard.
- Open-door policy, day one. Skip-level access to Sherrá is sanctioned.

New:

- **2** Websites
- Walk-in hours every fourth Friday, 1PM to 5 PM.
- Division Updates 2x/semester via video (Asynchronous)
- Focus groups July through December — 20 in-person + 20 online, monthly.
- Let's create Lunch & Learns (brown-bag edition)

Bidirectional accountability: information will be disseminated; staff are responsible for seeking it.

Reach to Alex anytime to schedule or ask for my booking link

Compensation

≈12 of 40 raised it

YOU ASKED

Wage equity. Cost-of-living lag. Watching colleagues leave because the math doesn't work.

WE ANSWER

- Salaries flow through student fees and legislative funding — not AVP discretion.
- The 0.5% sweep for promotions/equity is Student Affairs standard practice.
- The (2026) 2.5% COLA goes to all eligible staff.
- The 2024 \$50K floor was a presidential mandate.

Accountability

Multiple staff

YOU ASKED

Concerns about leadership accountability — particularly around staff retention and supervision.

WE ANSWER

Continued:

- New-staff 30-minute meet-and-greet is standard.
- Open-door policy, day one. Skip-level access to Sherrá is sanctioned.

New:

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Trust & Psychological Safety

≈8 of 40 — new theme

YOU ASKED

Not feeling safe to ask questions. Feeling unheard during personal health crises. Cultural belonging concerns.

WE ANSWER

- Acknowledgment, not a fix. Sustained behavior change is the work.
- Three T's: tone, tact, timing.
- Questioning leadership is not insubordination — it is the standard. Hold us accountable through the structures named today.

AT EVERY SEAT TODAY

The Hub exists because you asked for it.

“

It would be nice if there was a website with the SH&W happenings for our reference.

— pre-survey response

This response is the Hub, word for word.

That website now exists. It's at every seat in this room.

DIVISION HUB

Bookmark it.

Tell us what's missing.

wellnessattheu.github.io/wellness-hub

Updated monthly. Maintained for you.

Higher Ed health and wellness is changing fast.

INTEGRATION IS THE DIRECTION

Most universities are moving toward integrated care — shared space, shared EHR, shared records. Multiple modes, multiple combinations. The decisions we make about platforms, referrals, and clinical coordination are decisions about which integration model serves our students.

THE FIELD IS RETURNING TO BILLING

Many universities now bill insurance for mental health. Some outsource to academic medical centers or telehealth companies. We bill at the Student Health Center only — counseling stays free. Our model is the exception, not the rule. That is a deliberate choice about access.

THE PROVOST IS ASKING

Just months ago, the Provost asked whether we have had conversations about integrating mental health. The institutional question is not if — it is when, and on whose terms. Every clinician at this retreat is part of how we answer that.

WHERE INSTITUTIONAL ATTENTION LANDS

Counseling was the focus pre-2022. Campus Rec expansion has been the focus since. Keeling, AAAHC, and our SHC director have named SHC space inadequacy for a decade. The question is not which need is real. It is whether resource allocation is transparently mapped across all eight units.

This is not a fresh start. It is a response.

Many of the conditions named in this year's survey were named publicly five years ago. The work since has been the response to a documented institutional inheritance.

2021

Keeling External Review

"Siloed and splintered"

2023

SHC Space Inadequacy

Documented for a decade

2024

SMHF → Tuition

Fee revenue rolled in

0

Cuts to SHW

25%/15% exercise

Five years ago, an external review named the conditions. Two years ago, the SHC space inadequacy was named again in writing. Last fiscal year, the fee that funded much of this portfolio was rolled into tuition. And SHW took zero cuts in the 25%/15% budget exercise. The work since 2022 has been the response to that inheritance.

PART TWO

Know our story

Division History · Impact Report · Strategic Roadmap · KPIs

This has never happened before. Until now.

When I stepped into this role in 2022, not all of the departments we now call home were under one health and wellness line. Bringing every department under one roof — relationally, not just administratively — was the goal from day one.

Collaboration

Eleven departments. One division. We stop working in parallel and start working together.

Intentionality

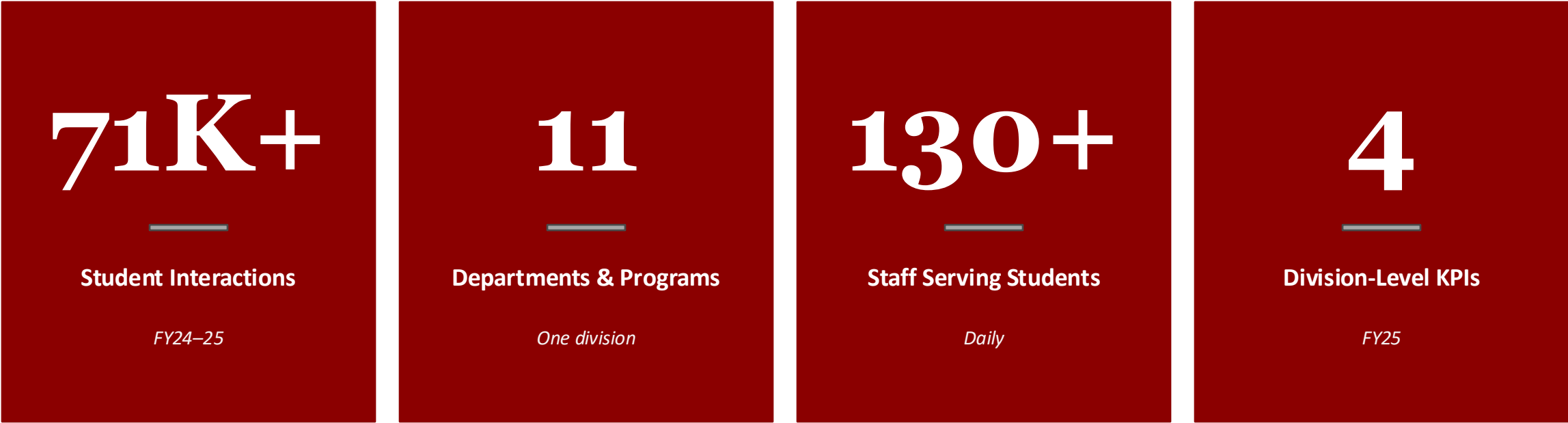
Every element of this retreat is designed with purpose. You will leave knowing more about your division than when you arrived.

Belonging

You belong in this room. Your department belongs in this division. That truth is not just stated — it is felt.

Our story in the data.

The 2021–2025 Integrated Findings & Impact Report has been in your hands for a month. Today is not a reveal — it's a conversation.



[Speaker notes — walk through 2-3 highlights that connect the data to where we are headed]

Inner rings reached. Institutional policy, not yet.

01

Suicide prevention task force

Program built. Task force not yet.

02

Incoming student wellness data

*One marker. No disaggregation.
Wellness assessment now rolling out.*

03

Stop-out wellness data

No aggregate question on why students leave.

04

Stop-out process simplification

Students navigate 4–5 departments to leave.

05

Hospital-discharge MOU

No formal continuity of care from hospital to campus.

06

Communicable disease + EM

SOP built. Institutional embedding pending.

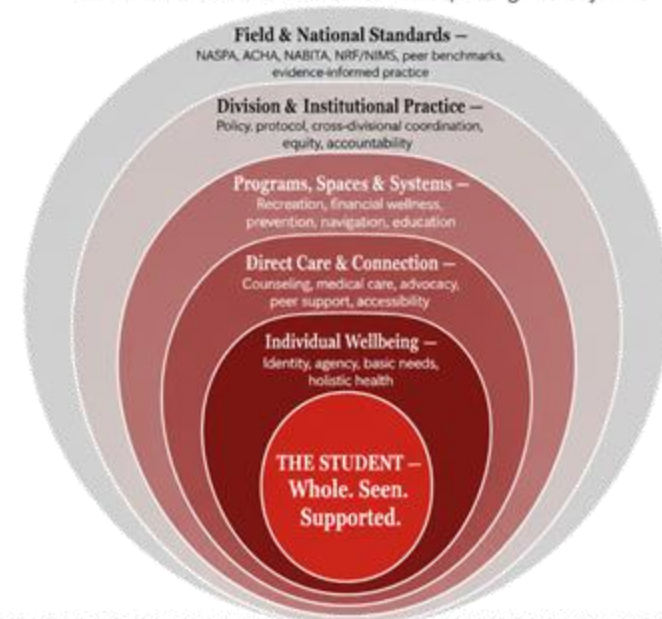
07

BIT inclusion + safety net

Documented across UCC, CDA, CCW, MH1, and AVP. Escalated.

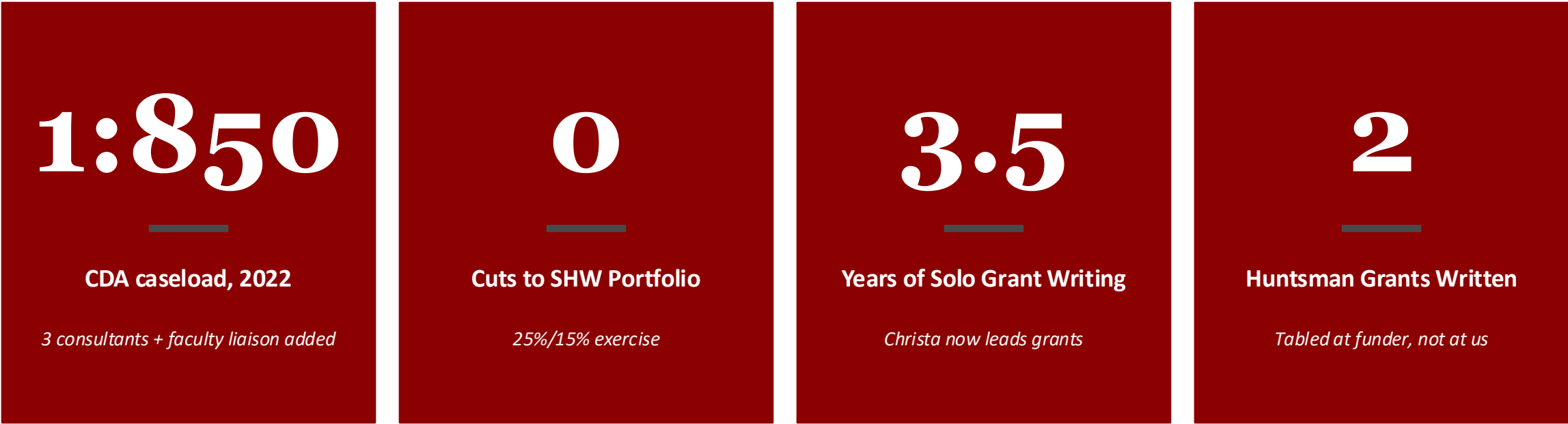
A Social-Ecological Model for Student Health & Wellness

How we hold the student at the center while operating across systems



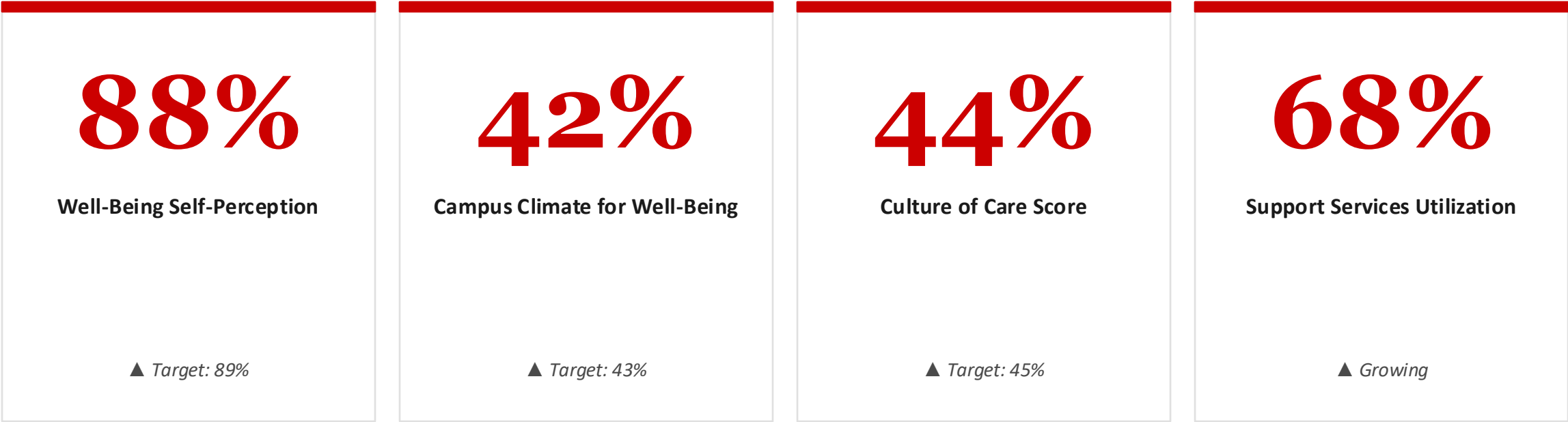
Every change has been data-driven.

Every position added since 2022 was tied to student data, staff data, or trend data. Three new disability consultants. Two financial wellness positions this fiscal year. New health educators. Recreation budget expansion. New counseling hire. And SHW took zero cuts in the 25%/15% budget exercise.



Two Huntsman grants written: a multidisciplinary case management team, and a complex specialty clinic for disordered eating, substance use, and complex cases — including possible psych NP and Indigenous spiritual wellness chaplain. Conversations active with HMHI and UHealth. The work to fill the gap is real and ongoing.

Where we're headed.



Every initiative on our roadmap is in service of one of these four numbers.

PART THREE

Know Our House

Four questions. Five minutes each. Seven departments.

Student Health Center

Mark Pfitzner – Cosplayed By: Gillian King

1 What did we do?

What matters most is our patients! We have a 97% overall satisfaction rate.

2 What are we building?

We are launching improved and expanded immunization compliance in Fall 2026.

3 What do we need from you?

Increased communication and coordination with referrals to other departments.

University Counseling Center

Scott McAward

1 What did we do?

UCC Served 2,719 students as of April 30 – an increase 9.20% YoY. This matters as supporting mental health is supporting retention, persistence, and success.

2 What are we building?

- Medical Student Wellness Program Alignment
- Capitol Reef Wellness Retreat

3 What do we need from you?

UCC would like to host a series of "Lunch & Collaborate" meetings with each department throughout Fall 2026 to strengthen cross-departmental partnerships.

Center for Campus Wellness

Brittany Badger

1 What did we do?

We have reached over 11,000 students, faculty, and staff through CCW events, workshops, and outreach.

2 What are we building?

- Wellness Exchange
- Chat with a peer well-being navigator

3 What do we need from you?

Active partnership in supporting students—
through timely referrals, shared planning on initiatives, and
coordination around emerging needs.

Center for Disability & Access

Christine Anderson

1 What did we do?

Exams Accommodations :
Significant responsibility of our office & Campus

2 What are we building?

Peer Mentor Program:
Assisting students in connection and personal discovery

3 What do we need from you?

Event Planning :
Consider accessibility when planning events

Campus Recreation Services

Ryan Kirchner (Interim)

1

What did we do?

550k+ swipes into ESLC

2

What are we building?

Data Driven Decisions (Snapshot)

3

What do we need from you?

Propose 1 new collaboration idea by fall end of 2026. No idea is too big or too small. Can be new or something you already do.

Financial Wellness Center

Gabrielle McAllaster

1

What did we do?

Increased financial counseling access and service capacity by 340-495%, eliminating 5+ week waiting times

2

What are we building?

- Prosperity Now – VITA Outreach Initiative
- Success 360

3

What do we need from you?

Strategic marketing and communications partnership with SH&W pilot marcomms to elevate financial wellness visibility

L U N C H · 1 2 : 4 0 P M

Staff Recognition Awards

FY25 Division Awards · Four categories · Surprise announcements

Every nomination was an act of noticing. Every name read is someone who made this year better for students and colleagues.

Student Impact

For an employee whose work has made a meaningful and lasting difference in the student experience.

Robbie Gordon, LCSW, SUDC

Clinical Staff

*Medical Student Wellness Program
Nominated by Dr. Meghan Sullivan*

Elisa Gott

Peer Mentor (Student Staff)

*Financial Wellness Center
Nominated by FWC*

Harold Suxo Mendoza

Graduate Assistant

*Center for Campus Wellness
Nominated by Brittany Badger*

Leadership & Initiative

For an employee who leads beyond their title, takes initiative, and positively influences programs, teams, or outcomes.

Rev. Cindy Solomon-Klebba

Spiritual Wellness Program (Volunteer)

Center for Campus Wellness
Nominated by Dr. Sherrá Watkins

Beth Hunsaker

Associate Director

Financial Wellness Center
Nominated by FWC

Breanna (Bre) Lambert, LCSW

Clinical Staff

University Counseling Center
Nominated by Scott McAward

Randi Spencer

Administrative Manager

Student Health Center
Nominated by Gillian, Mark & Katherine

Emma Barcenas, LCSW

Clinical Staff

Medical Student Wellness Program
Nominated by Dr. Meghan Sullivan

Innovation & Improvement

For an employee who strengthens processes, builds sustainable systems, or improves service delivery.

Adam Hodson

Aquatics Operations & Program Manager

Campus Recreation (Aquatics)
Nominated by Ryan Kirchner

Malcolm Harrison

Front Desk Specialist & Website Coordinator

University Counseling Center
Nominated by Scott McAward

Kate Dixon, LCSW

Clinical Staff

Medical Student Wellness Program
Nominated by Dr. Meghan Sullivan

Char Leary, CSW, MSW

Associate Director of Advocacy Services

Center for Campus Wellness
Nominated by Brittany Badger

Service Excellence

For an employee who consistently demonstrates professionalism, dependability, expertise, and exceptional service.

Elsa Osborne

Program Coordinator

Financial Wellness Center
Nominated by FWC

Jeremy Smolik

Operations Specialist

Campus Recreation (Operations)
Nominated by Ryan Kirchner

Rhanden Lind

Front Desk Coordinator

Center for Disability & Access
Nominated by Christine Anderson

TEAM UPDATE

WELCOME OUR NEW Director of Strategy & Operations

Mrs. Gillian King

PART FOUR

Connect the dots

Interactive Activity · Lunch · Staff Recognition Awards

Now we play.

Maze to Map

Case Scenarios

You all took a number when you walked in.

Now, everyone move to the table that corresponds to your number. There are 2 tables for each number, and we want staff from each department at every table.

[Slide Deck](#)

PART SIX

Tend what's yours

Wellness Your Way · Closing Circle · Adjourn

You choose. Five stations. No wrong answer.

01

Movement

Stretch. Breathe. Walk.

02

Reflection

Journal. Sit. Notice.

03

Creativity

Make. Sketch. Express.

04

Community

Connect. Share. Listen.

05

Rest

Quiet. Still. Recover.

This is the live demonstration of our branding campaign — and a gift to every person in this room.

One word. One commitment. One thing you're taking back.

ONE WORD

*How are you walking out?
Different than when you
walked in?*

ONE COMMITMENT

*What's one thing you'll do
differently because of today?*

ONE THING

*What are you taking back to
your team — to share with
someone who isn't here?*

3 : 0 0 P M · A D J O U R N

The road continues.

Now we build it together.

Thank you. For being here. For caring about students. For speaking plainly.